



VANCOUVER FASHION WEEK

VFW CONSOLE.

User Manual — how each role uses every module

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SIGNING IN AND GETTING ACCESS

WHAT YOU MIGHT SEE – KNOWN QUIRKS

VFW Console is the system Van Fashion Week (and its sister events, VKFW and GFC) uses to run the business side of a fashion show: booking a designer's package, getting the sale approved and invoiced, tracking payments, running payroll, messaging colleagues, and reporting on how the season is going.

This manual is organized the same way the app is organized. Each section below covers one screen — what it's for, and exactly what each of the five staff roles can see and do there. If you only ever use two or three screens, you can skip straight to those sections; the first two sections (the roles, and how permissions work) are worth reading once regardless of your role, because they explain *why* certain buttons are missing or greyed out for you — it is deliberate, not a bug.

THE FIVE ROLES

Every person who signs in holds exactly one of five roles. A role decides which screens you can open and which actions you can take; it does **not** decide which *records* you can see within a screen — that is a separate rule, covered in each module's section below (in short: most staff see their own work, while Accounting, Sales Management and Administration see everyone's).

ROLE	WHO THIS IS
User	The standard staff account: someone who sells a package to a designer and owns the relationship with that account, and anyone else who does day-to-day work in the console without needing one of the specialist roles below.
Intern	A supervised trainee learning the sales role. Can draft and manage sales the same way a User can, but does not yet get the customer contact book or the feedback tools — those hold designers' personal contact details.
Accounting	Reviews and approves sales, handles invoicing, payments, and the QuickBooks hand-off, and is a second administrator for the whole system.
Sales Manager	Oversees the sales team's numbers and hours. Can see everything a User can see, and more — but cannot create, approve, or export a sale, and cannot see anyone's pay. This role watches the business, it doesn't operate the money side of it.
Administrator	Full access, including everything Accounting can do, plus system configuration: user accounts, the product catalogue, and settings.

A few things worth understanding up front, because they explain a lot of what follows:

- **"User" is the name of a role, not just "somebody using the console."** Everyone who signs in is using the system; only the accounts on this particular role are labelled **User**. It was called *Sales Representative* until recently and was renamed because it had stopped being sales-only — salespeople and other staff are both on it, and a

person on this role who never sells anything is perfectly normal. Nothing about what the role can do changed with the name.

- **Accounting and Administrator are equals.** Both can approve sales, manage the catalogue, and manage user accounts. Accounting holds this so that account recovery (for example, restoring a locked-out Administrator) never depends on one single person being reachable. The trade-off is real and worth knowing: anyone who can change roles can promote themselves to Administrator, so this is a high-trust position on both sides.
- **The Sales Manager sees more than they can act on.** A manager can see every sale, every report, and every team member's hours — but cannot create a sale, approve one, or export one. That authority stays with Accounting and Administration.
- **"Who can approve" and "who can see" are different questions,** and the system is strict about keeping them separate. A rule you'll see repeated throughout this manual: whoever *creates or requests* something is never the same person who *approves* it — even an Administrator cannot approve their own submitted work.
- **A role decides which screens you see; a second, separate rule decides whose records you see on them.** Someone on the User role looking at Submissions sees only their own deals; Accounting, Sales Management and Administration see everyone's. This "row scoping" is called out explicitly wherever it applies.

WORK

DASHBOARD

The landing screen after you sign in. Accounting and Administrators see what is currently waiting on their approval; everyone else sees a summary of their own open work.

Everyone can see this screen — it just shows different things depending on your role.

NEW SUBMISSION

This is how a sale gets entered into the system: choose the contact/designer, the show, a package, any add-ons, a discount if one applies, and a deposit.

Who can create a submission: Users, Interns, and Administrators. Accounting and Sales Managers do not create sales — they review them.

What happens when you submit:

1. You choose the show, the package, and any add-ons. The screen shows you a running total as you build the sale — but it is clearly labeled *"Indicative only."* The real total is calculated by the server the moment you submit, from the same rate card, and that

number is the one that counts. You are not trusted to type in a price, and neither is anyone else — the system always calculates the total itself.

2. **A discount only ever reduces the package price — never the add-ons.** If you apply a 10% discount to a package plus add-ons, only the package portion is discounted.
3. **Commission is calculated on the discounted price, before tax** — never on the tax itself, and never on the full sticker price before your discount. You are paid on the actual revenue you brought in.
4. If a payment schedule (installments) is agreed with the designer, you can set that up right away, and mark payments as received as they come in — more on this under **Submissions** below.
5. The sale is created in **Pending** status and goes to the Approval queue.

Customizing a package for one sale. You are not limited to the catalogue exactly as priced. On any individual sale you can change the price, rename the package, change what's included, or build something entirely custom for that designer. This does not touch the catalogue for anyone else — it is a one-time deviation for this sale only. It does, however, flag the sale for an extra approval step (see **Approval queue** below), because Accounting needs to knowingly sign off on a non-standard deal.

A contact is created automatically. The first time you submit a sale for a new brand, that brand is added to the Contacts book automatically — you don't need to add it separately first.

SUBMISSIONS

The list of every sale you're allowed to see, with a detail page for each one.

	USER / INTERN	ACCOUNTING	SALES MANAGER	ADMINISTRATOR
See the list	Own sales only	Everyone's	Everyone's	Everyone's
Edit a sale before approval	Own sales	Any	—	Any
Edit a sale after approval	—	Any (as an "Amend")	—	Any
Approve, reject, or return a sale	—	Yes	—	Yes
Generate/download the invoice	—	Yes	—	Yes
Send the invoice by email	—	Yes	—	Yes
Record or undo a payment	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Void a sale (soft-delete)	—	Yes	—	Yes

Opening a sale. Clicking anywhere on a row (or pressing Enter on it) opens a quick-look panel over the list: the customer and designer, the show, package and rep, the dates it was submitted and approved, and the full money breakdown in the currency the sale was made in — package, add-ons, any discount, net revenue, tax, total, paid, balance and commission — plus the sales notes if any were left. It is read-only; **Open full record** takes you to the detail page where the sale is actually worked on. Escape or a click outside closes it. This is a faster way to check a figure than loading the whole record, and it works the same way on the Dashboard's submissions card and on the voided list.

Editing a sale, in plain terms. Before a sale is approved, it belongs to whoever created it (or Accounting/Admin, who can fix anyone's mistake). The button reads **Edit**. Once a sale is approved, only Accounting or an Administrator can still change it, and the button changes to **Amend** — amending keeps the sale's approval rather than sending it back through the queue. If a sale has already been sent to QuickBooks, the screen warns you that QuickBooks will not automatically pick up any change you make there — someone will need to fix it on the QuickBooks side by hand.

The invoice number. Before a sale is approved, its invoice number (if one is typed in early) belongs to whoever can edit the sale. After approval, only Accounting or an Administrator can set or change it — by then it may already be on a document in a client's inbox, and the screen reminds you of that risk before you save a change.

Payment plans (installments). Anyone who can work a sale — not just Accounting — can set up a payment schedule and mark installments as paid. The thinking here: whoever sold the deal is usually the one talking to the designer about payment, so they shouldn't have to route every payment update through Accounting. Two different actions are involved:

- **Scheduling a plan** just sets expectations — it does not move any money and can be adjusted freely.
- **Marking an installment paid** posts a real payment to the ledger and reduces the sale's balance.

Undoing a payment never erases it. If a payment is marked paid by mistake, "undo" adds a matching negative entry rather than deleting the original — so the payment history always shows exactly what happened, including corrections. This is on purpose: a financial record you can quietly edit is a financial record you can't trust.

Voiding a sale is a soft delete — Accounting or an Administrator can void a sale to hide it from lists and reports, but it isn't gone. It's kept for the audit trail and can be reversed.

CONTACTS

The customer book — every designer/brand you've sold to, searchable by brand, designer name, or company.

Who can see it: Users, Accounting, Sales Managers, and Administrators. **Interns cannot** — the contact book holds designers' personal emails and phone numbers, and an intern is

a supervised trainee who doesn't yet get access to that.

Who can add a contact directly: Users, Accounting, and Administrators (not Sales Managers, not Interns).

A User sees only the brands they've personally sold to or entered; other roles see everyone's. Opening a contact shows their **lifetime value** (the total of everything they've bought that was actually approved — a returned or rejected deal doesn't count) and their full history of sales with you.

MESSAGES

Real-time internal chat with your colleagues — direct messages or group chats. Everyone can use it, and there's no restriction on who you can message. A small badge on the navigation menu shows how many unread messages you have.

EMAILS

A log of every email the system has sent or received on your behalf — verification codes, invitations, password resets, and invoices.

Everyone can open this screen, but what you see depends on your role: Users and Interns see only mail connected to them; Accounting, Sales Managers, and Administrators see the full company log. **Sending** an invoice by email is an accounting action (Accounting and Administrators only) and is done from the sale itself, not from this screen — this screen is where you go afterward to confirm it actually sent.

APPROVAL QUEUE

Where Accounting and Administrators review sales that are waiting for sign-off. Users can also open this screen — to see where their own submission currently sits — but cannot act on it.

Why reading and deciding are separate permissions: the person who created a sale should be able to check on its status without needing to ask someone else. But *acting* on it — approving, rejecting, or sending it back — has to stay with someone who didn't create it. That is the "maker and checker must be different people" rule mentioned earlier, applied here directly.

What happens when Accounting reviews a sale:

- **A normal sale** opens a simple approval box: enter a GL account and cost centre, and approve.
- **A sale discounted more than the company's threshold** (15% by default, but this is configurable) will not approve with a simple click. The system refuses and tells you exactly why:

"This sale is discounted 25.00%, above the 15.00% that needs accounting sign-off. Re-send with acknowledgeDiscountOverride: true to approve it anyway."

In the screen, this appears as a checkbox you must explicitly tick before the Approve button will submit. This is deliberate friction: a deep discount should never be approved without someone consciously saying "yes, I saw that and I'm approving it anyway." That acknowledgment is recorded in the sale's history. - **A sale with a customized or non-catalogue package** (see **New submission** above) needs its own, *separate* sign-off — acknowledging the discount is not enough on its own. The approval box shows the rate-card price side by side with what was actually charged, so the approver can see exactly what they're agreeing to before ticking the box. A sale can trigger both checks at once, and both must be ticked. - **Returning a sale** requires a written reason — you cannot send a sale back to a rep without explaining why. It lands in a "Returned to sales" list, where the rep can fix it and resubmit — there's a shortcut to edit it directly from that list.

QUICKBOOKS

Where approved sales get exported to the company's QuickBooks accounting system, and a ledger of everything already exported.

Who can use it: Accounting and Administrators only.

Exporting posts the sale as an invoice in QuickBooks and marks it as "Exported" in VFW Console. Once a sale is exported, editing it in VFW Console still works, but you're warned that the change will **not** automatically update QuickBooks — someone has to fix the QuickBooks side separately.

PEOPLE

ATTENDANCE

Your monthly timesheet — a calendar where each day can be marked with a status, clock-in/clock-out times, or a note, plus quick Clock In / Clock Out buttons for today.

Everyone can see and mark their own attendance. Accounting, Sales Managers, and Administrators additionally get a **Team** tab showing every active staff member's month at a glance — including people who recorded nothing at all, which is the point of that view (it surfaces gaps, not just entries). Opening a person from the Team tab lets a manager correct their day if needed, and any correction made by someone other than the person themselves is recorded and clearly labeled as a correction, not a self-report.

A couple of details worth knowing:

- If you enter both a start and finish time, your hours are calculated from those times automatically — a typed total is only used when times aren't given, so your record can never contradict itself.
- Each day can only have one record. Re-entering a day overwrites what was there before, rather than adding a second entry.

PAYROLL

What you (or, if you have the right access, everyone) earned in a given period, broken down into base pay, commission, and the total.

	EVERYONE	ACCOUNTING / ADMINISTRATOR
See your own pay	Yes	Yes
See everyone's pay	—	Yes
Submit your period for approval	Yes	Yes
Approve/reject submitted pay	—	Yes

Choosing the period. The screen opens on the current calendar month and the ‹ › arrows step a month at a time, which is what most payroll runs are. **Custom range...** swaps those arrows for two date boxes so a period can be anything else: a biweekly cycle, someone's final two weeks before they leave, a one-off correction window. Everything on the screen follows the period you pick — the statement, the run, the sales panel, and the payslip you download. A period that happens to run from the 1st to the last of a month is still just called *August 2026*; anything else is spelled out end to end.

Sales Managers do not see anyone's pay figures, including their own team's — even though they *can* see the team's hours in Attendance. This is the sharpest line in the whole permission system: "is my team showing up?" and "what does my team earn?" are treated as genuinely different questions, answered to different people.

How your pay is calculated, in plain terms:

- **Base pay** depends on your pay type, set by Administration: a flat salary, an hourly rate multiplied by your logged hours, or no base at all if you're paid on commission only.
- **Whether you're on commission** is a separate setting, so an account can be paid on commission, on a salary, or on both. If you're not on commission, the statement says so beside the commission line rather than showing you a rate you aren't earning at.
- **Commission** is the total commission on every sale you closed that was *approved* in that period (not just submitted) — using the commission rate that was locked in when each sale was made, so a rate change today never moves money already earned. Coming off commission works the same way: it stops your next sale earning any and never rewrites one already on the books.

- The screen also shows how much of your commission is tied to invoices the client hasn't paid yet — this doesn't reduce what you're owed, it's just shown so nobody is surprised that some of their "earned" total is still outstanding.

The sales behind the commission. Under the statement is a *Sales* panel showing what that person actually sold in the period: how many deals, the net revenue commission is struck on, the commission itself, progress against their target, what has been collected against what is still outstanding, and a **Who it came from** table breaking the period down client by client.

The panel has its own **Export** button — PDF, Excel or CSV — which hands over the client breakdown for whichever period is on screen. Every row repeats the period and the person, so several exports can be stacked into one sheet to build up a longer history. Whose figures you can export is decided the same way the screen decides: your own always, anyone else's only if you can already see their pay.

The same panel appears on an account in Administration → Users & roles, from the same figures — so the two screens can never give different answers about what somebody sold.

Downloading a payslip. The *Payslip (PDF)* button on the period you are looking at produces a one-page document you can print, file or send on. It shows the period and the person it is for, how they are paid, each earnings line beside the arithmetic it came from (rate x hours, or the sales behind the commission), the attendance and sales the figures were derived from, and — if the period has been submitted for approval — its status, who reviewed it and when. It is the same statement as the screen, never a second calculation, so the two can never disagree.

The same rule as the screen decides whose payslip you can pull: your own always, anyone else's only if you can already see their pay. Every payslip produced is recorded in the audit trail, including your own — a document that gets forwarded should be traceable to whoever produced it.

Submitting and approving pay. Your statement is calculated fresh every time you open it — nothing is saved until you actually submit it for approval. Submitting freezes the figures for that exact period, so a timesheet or a sale corrected afterwards will not quietly move what you claimed; if the two drift apart, the screen says so and you can resubmit. Once submitted, Accounting can review the figures, edit them if needed (always with a required written reason — the save button stays disabled until you type one), and then approve or reject. As with sale approvals, you cannot approve your own submission, no matter your role. Once approved, the amount counts toward your running lifetime earnings total, visible on this screen and on your Account page.

One submission exists per person per period, so resubmitting the same range replaces your earlier claim rather than adding a second one. Submitting a *different* range is a separate claim — overlapping periods are not detected for you, so agree the cycle with Accounting before switching off calendar months.

LEADERBOARD

Ranks active accounts on the **User** role by performance over a chosen period. Everyone can see it — showing everyone's numbers to everyone is the entire point of a leaderboard. (The screen still calls these accounts "representatives" in a couple of places; it means the same people.)

Ranking is based on a score, not raw revenue, made up of: revenue against target, how many of your submissions get approved, how much of what you've sold has actually been collected, and repeat business from your customers. Someone who blows past their revenue target doesn't get extra credit for the excess — the revenue portion of the score caps at 100% of target, so consistently *collecting* what you sell and keeping customers coming back matter just as much as closing the sale in the first place.

Feedback and internal notes never affect this score, on purpose — even a glowing or scathing note about a rep has zero effect on where they rank. Those tools (below) are for coaching, not for scoring.

DESIGNER FEEDBACK

Star ratings and notes left by designers about their experience.

Who can see or record it: Accounting, Sales Managers, and Administrators. Users and Interns cannot access this screen.

Feedback is attached to the *designer/brand*, not to one specific sale — so feedback recorded on one deal will show up against every deal for that same brand, past and future.

INTERNAL NOTES

Internal operational comments about a specific sale — used by Accounting, Production, Marketing, and Event Management teams to coordinate, kept strictly out of anything client-facing.

Who can see or write these: Accounting, Sales Managers, and Administrators.

The one rule that overrides even being an Administrator: nobody can ever read internal notes about their *own* sale — not even an Administrator who also happens to be the rep on that deal. If that applies to you, the entire Internal Notes section simply won't appear on that sale's page. This is not a bug or a missing feature — it's intentional, so a note about a person is never visible to that same person, regardless of what else their role allows.

INSIGHT

REPORTS

Ten different report types covering revenue, sales by event, sales by city, package popularity, customer retention, outstanding receivables, payment collection, individual rep performance, designer feedback trends, and internal comment trends.

Who can see it: Accounting, Sales Managers, and Administrators.

Every consolidated figure is converted to the company's reporting currency (CAD) using exchange rates that Administration keeps up to date — figures in different currencies are never simply added together without conversion.

AUDIT TRAIL

A permanent, read-only record of business events across the whole system — who approved what, who changed what, and when.

Who can see it: Accounting, Sales Managers, and Administrators.

This record cannot be edited or deleted by anyone, at any role, including Administrators. It exists specifically so that nothing important can be quietly changed or covered up after the fact.

SYSTEM

ADMINISTRATION

The control panel for who has access, what things cost, and how the system behaves.

Who can use it: Accounting and Administrators. As mentioned earlier, Accounting holds this so account recovery never depends on a single person — but it also means anyone with this access could, in principle, promote themselves further, so it's held only by the two most trusted roles.

TAB	WHAT IT'S FOR
Invitations & approvals	Send an invitation to a new hire (with their role already fixed), cancel an invitation, and approve new sign-ups before they can log in.

TAB	WHAT IT'S FOR
Users & roles	See every staff account and change someone's role, pay type, pay rate, and whether they earn commission (so a person can be on commission, on a salary, or on both). Opening an account also shows what they have sold and to whom — the same Sales panel Payroll shows, from the same figures. Here it steps a calendar month at a time (the custom-range picker lives on Payroll), so you can look back over an account's history from the screen where you set their rate.
Packages & pricing	Manage the seasons, the shows, the package catalogue, and the add-on catalogue that sales are built from. Seasons are maintained here as a list ("Fall/Winter 26") so a show is picked from it rather than retyped — add one before adding the show that uses it. Renaming or removing a season only changes what the New show form offers next; shows already on the books keep the season they were created with.
Tax rates	Manage the tax rates applied when a sale is priced.
Settings	The discount threshold that triggers extra sign-off, invoice numbering, and the currency exchange rates used everywhere else in the system.
Configuration	System-level settings that take effect immediately, without needing a technical deployment.

A catalogue change never rewrites history. If you change a package's price or a tax rate tomorrow, every sale already made keeps the price and rate it was actually sold at — nothing already sold is silently recalculated. Adding a new show, package, or add-on only ever adds a new option; it never removes or changes anyone's existing deal.

LOGS

A record of how the *console itself* is being used — sign-ins, what screens people opened, and messaging activity. This is different from the Audit trail: Logs is about system usage, the Audit trail is about business decisions.

Who can see it: Accounting and Administrators only. This is treated as sensitive, HR-adjacent information, so it's held to the same two roles that hold full administrative authority.

TAB	WHAT IT SHOWS
Users	Per-person usage summary and who's currently online.
Activity	A stream of individual actions — one row per event.
Sessions	Individual sign-in sessions, with device and how long each lasted.

CONSOLE (REACHED FROM YOUR PROFILE MENU, NOT THE MAIN NAVIGATION)

SETTINGS

Your personal preferences — currently just light/dark/system theme. Available to everyone.

ACCOUNT

Your own profile — name, job title, phone number, department, and a profile picture — plus your password. Available to everyone, and this is the *only* screen where you can change your own profile.

A couple of things worth knowing:

- Fields like your role, pay rate, and commission percentage are shown here for reference but **cannot** be edited by you — those are set by an Administrator or Accounting through the Administration screen. You genuinely cannot give yourself a raise from this screen, even by accident.
- Changing your password signs you out of every other device you're logged into, except the one you're using to make the change. This is a security measure — if someone else had access to your account, changing your password locks them out immediately.

SIGNING IN AND GETTING ACCESS

VFW Console is invite-only — you cannot sign up on your own without an invitation code from an Administrator or Accounting.

1. You receive an invitation code with your role already assigned.
2. You sign up using that code and verify your email address with a one-time code sent to you.
3. An Administrator or Accounting approves your account.
4. You can now sign in.

If you forget your password, use the "forgot password" link to receive a reset link by email. That link works exactly once and expires after a set window — if it's already been used or has expired, you'll need to request a new one.

WHAT YOU MIGHT SEE — KNOWN QUIRKS

A few things you might notice while using the system that are worth understanding, so they don't cause confusion.

A discount percentage shown in the Approval queue can look slightly different from the one that actually decides whether extra sign-off is needed. The queue's displayed number is calculated slightly differently than the number the approval rule itself uses, so on a sale with several add-ons the two can disagree by a percentage point or two — and the number shown in the queue is always the *lower* of the two. If you're an approver and a sale asks for the extra discount sign-off even though the queue showed a percentage under the threshold, that's this quirk, not an error — trust the number the approval screen gives you at the moment of approving, not the one in the list.

Some screens can show "no results" when the real problem is a connection issue, not an empty list. If a screen that should clearly have data (for example, a list of sessions or a report you know has entries) shows "nothing found," it's worth refreshing the page before assuming the data is really gone — a small number of screens don't yet distinguish "genuinely empty" from "the request failed."

Some elements are hard to read in dark mode. The active tab label on a couple of screens (for example, the Emails screen's Sent/Received switch) can render with very low contrast in dark mode, making it look like nothing is selected even though it is. Switching to light mode, or simply trusting which tab you clicked, works fine in the meantime.

The #3 ranking badge on the Leaderboard can be hard to see in dark mode, for the same kind of contrast reason as above — the rank is still correct, it's just visually faint.

This manual reflects the system as of August 2026. If a screen you're using doesn't match what's described here, check with an Administrator — the system does evolve, and this document should be kept in step with it.